A true story

She was Sri Lanka's best batter.

Hiruka Fernando was the first Sri Lankan woman to score 1,000 ODI runs.

Then she had a baby.

> **"When she returned to the side after her baby, her batting fell off quite quickly and she had no choice but to retire."**
>
> Chamari Athapaththu, Sri Lanka, on Hiruka Fernando

Source: The Cricket Monthly, 8 March 2022



Chamari Athapaththu tells Hiruka's story

Chamari Athapaththu, Sri Lanka. Photo: Bahnfrend, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons.



Pakistan’s first woman to score an ODI century

Nain Abidi, Women's World Cup 2009. Photo: paddynapper, CC BY-SA 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons.

Was she the only one?

No. Pakistan's Nain Abidi felt it too.

> **"Years of work building muscles disappeared just like that. My heart sank."**
>
> Nain Abidi, after giving birth

> **"usually signalled the end of her career"**
>
> The Australian Cricketers' Association chief executive, on pregnancy in women's cricket, 2019

Sources: The Cricket Monthly, 8 March 2022. MLP Law, 18 November 2019.

So has anything changed?

Yes. The ICC wrote a plan for mothers.

June 2026. Six stages back to cricket:

1. Ready
2. Review
3. Restore
4. Recondition
5. Return
6. Refine

But it is a **9-page PDF**.

- x No way to track her progress
- x No safe check of her body
- x No doctor sign-off
- x No local languages

Sources: ICC media release, 22 June 2026. FIFA's July 2026 guidance is flowcharts too; its authors say guidelines "lack actionable frameworks on the how" (University of Alberta, July 2026).



ICC Return to Play Post-Pregnancy Guidelines, 2026.

What if the plan lived in her pocket?

ComeBack

The ICC's plan, turned into a guided journey back to cricket. On any phone. In her own language.

1

She knows her stage

A clear map, made for her.

2

She checks in on camera

Her phone watches her move.

3

Her doctor decides

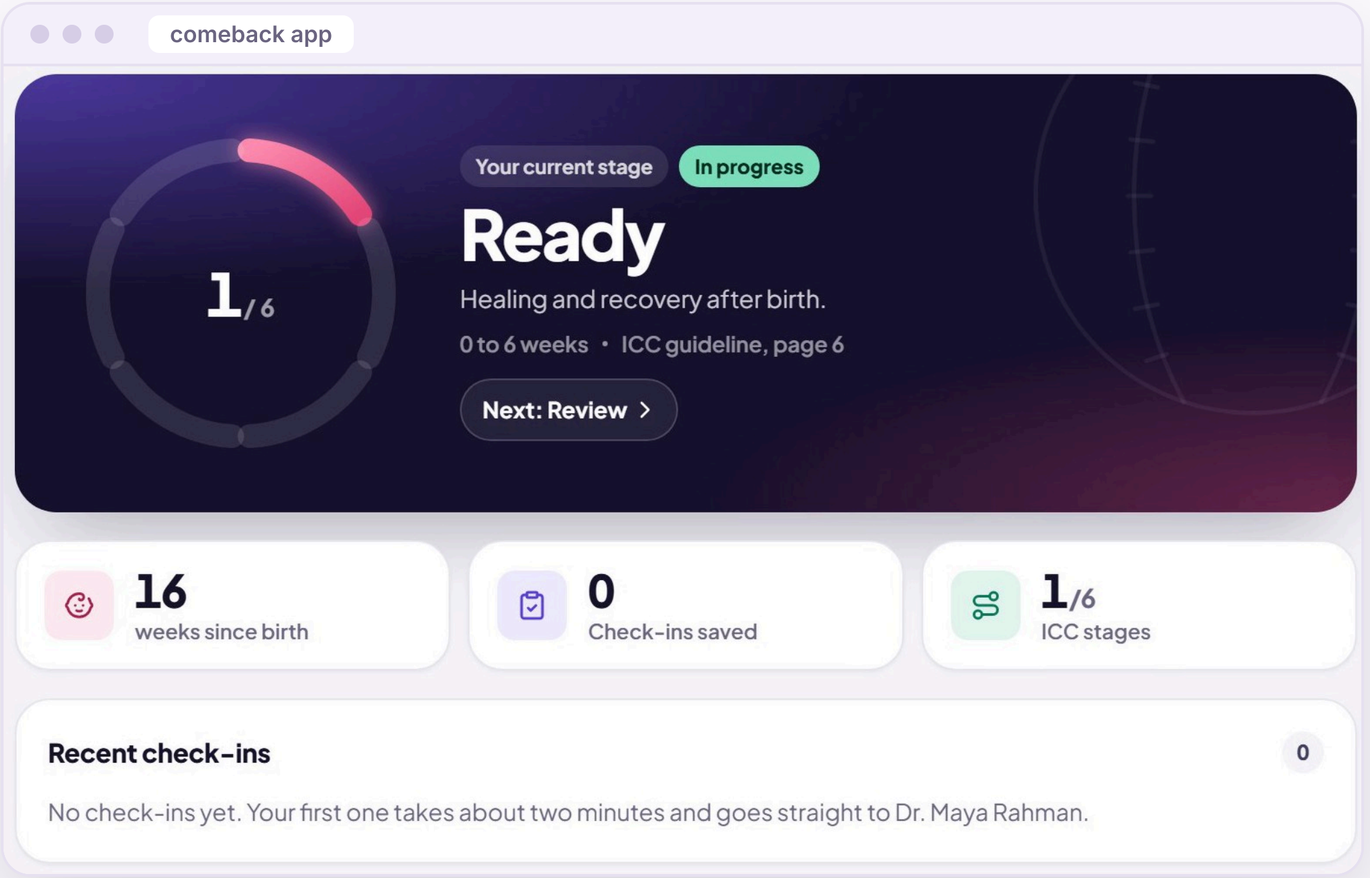
A real clinician approves every step.

Let's follow one mother. Meet **Sana**, a pace bowler. Her baby was born 16 weeks ago, by caesarean.

Step 1. Where am I?

Sana opens the app and sees her stage.

- Stage 1 of 6: **Ready**
- Every step shows the **ICC page** it comes from
- The plan fits **her**: her birth, her weeks, her role

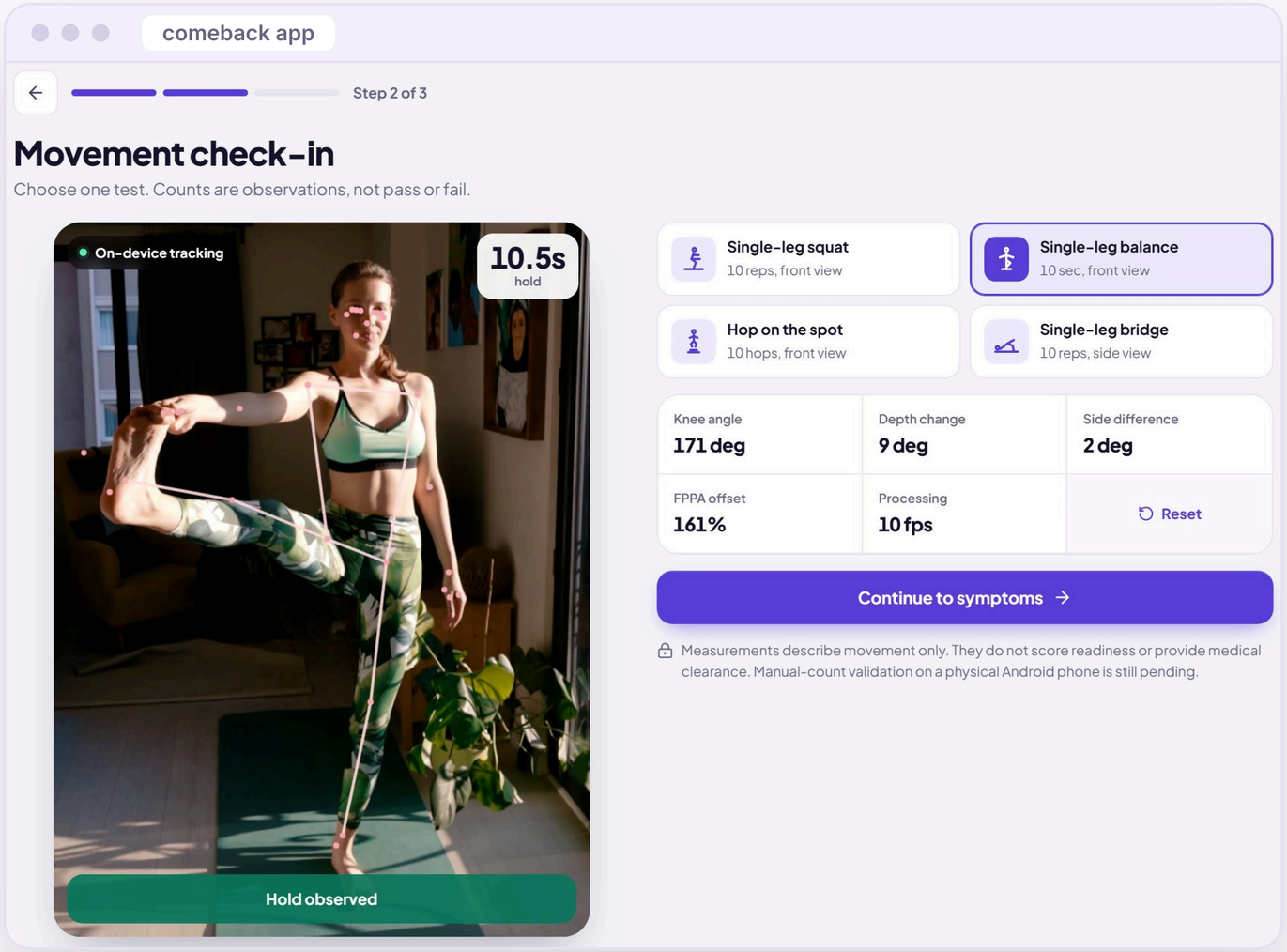


Step 2. Is my body ready?

She puts her phone on the floor and moves.

- AI on the phone **counts reps** and **times holds**
- Four simple tests from postnatal experts
- The video **never leaves her phone**

Tests: Goom, Donnelly and Brockwell, 2019. Demo camera input: stock video (Pexels).

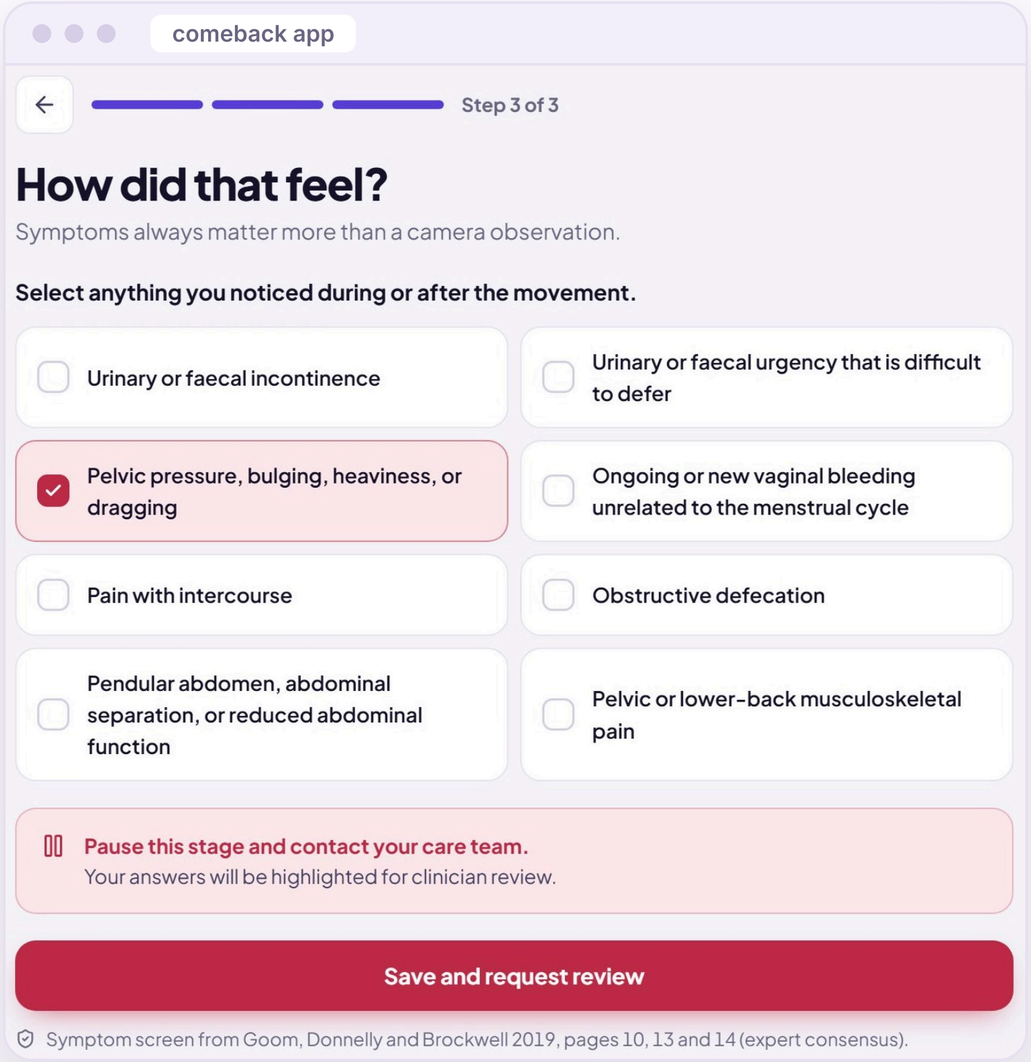


Step 3. How did it feel?

Her body always comes first.

- She answers a short symptom check
- One warning sign and her stage **stops**
- The app tells her: **contact your care team**

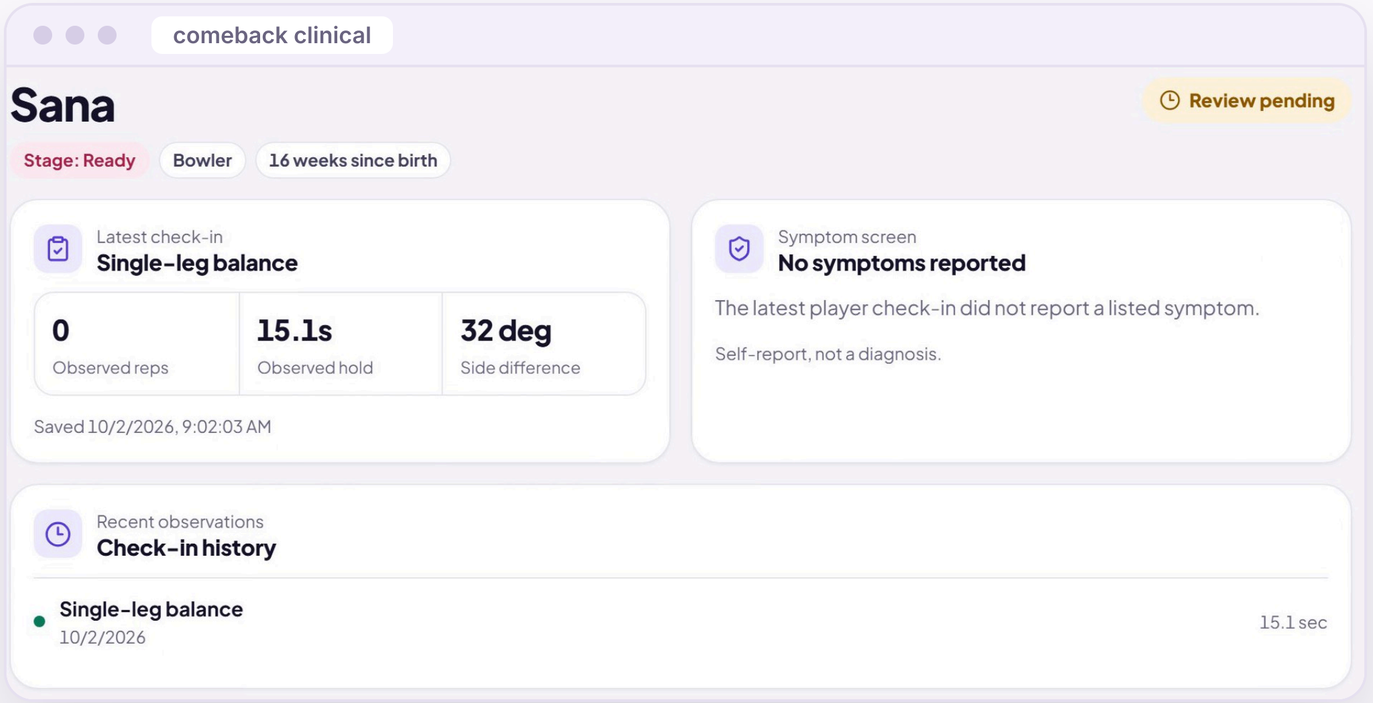
Symptom screen: Goom, Donnelly and Brockwell, 2019, pages 10, 13 and 14.

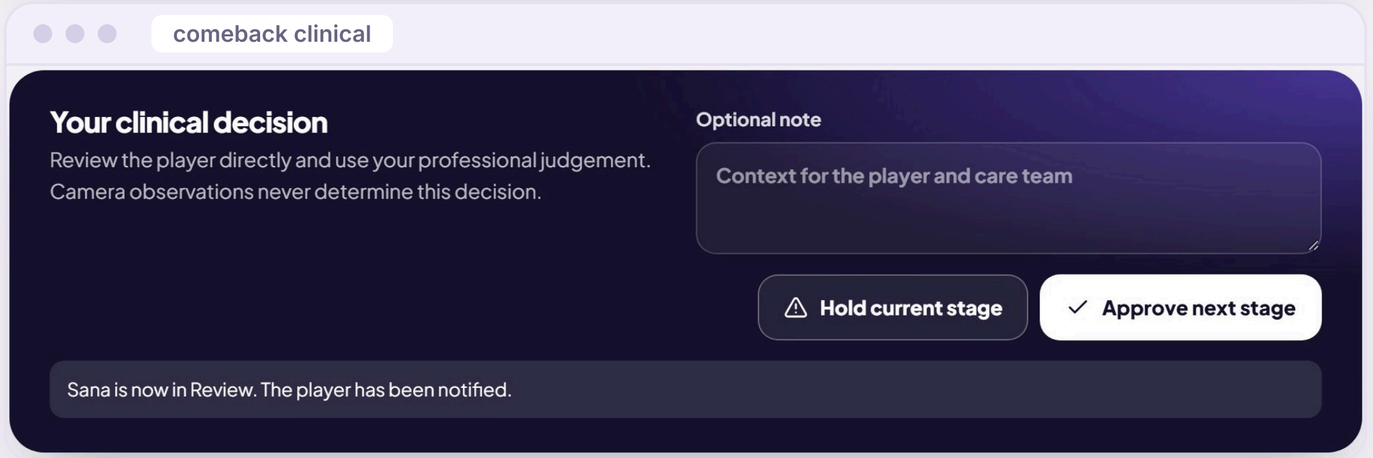


Step 4. Who decides?

A real doctor. Never the app.

- Her physio sees the check-in, the numbers and any symptoms
- Then she presses **Approve** or **Hold**
- Sana is notified right away

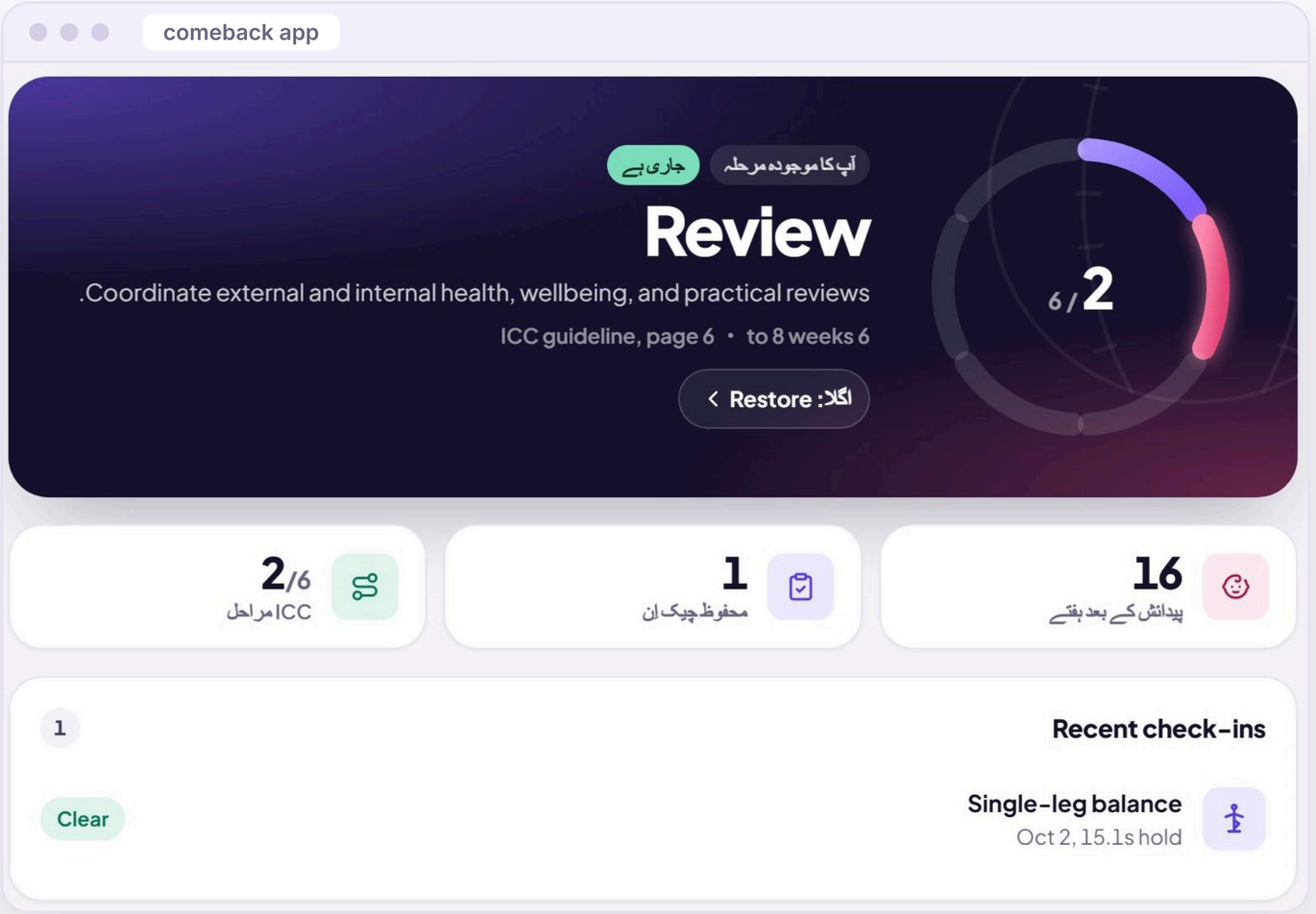




Step 5. What happens next?

Sana moves to stage 2. One step closer to the field.

- In **English, Bengali, Hindi or Urdu**
- Works **offline**, on any phone
- An AI guide explains her stage, but **never** decides it
- Private chat with her doctor



Why should ComeBack win?

Five reasons.

1

Built on the ICC’s own plan

The first working app for the 2026 guidelines. Ready to pilot with ICC Members.

2

It works today

Live app, real AI on the phone. 60 unit tests and 18 full user journeys pass.

3

Safe by design

A doctor approves every stage. Warning signs stop progress. Video stays private.

4

For every mother

Free, any phone, offline, four languages. The same need exists in football and beyond.

5

Built by women, for women

An all-women team, solving a problem only women face.





Bismah Maroof. Photo: paddynapper, CC BY-SA 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons.

Picture the next mother.

> **"No player should have to choose between motherhood and representing her country."**
>
> 
> Jay Shah, ICC Chairman, 22 June 2026

ComeBack makes sure she never has to.



Thank you.

Nourin Zaman and Ashra Rahman

Try the live app: scan the code.

Appendix A. Want to try it?

See it, test it, read the code

Live app

nourinzaman2005-droid.github.io/comeback

Demo video, 2:56

youtu.be/HjBi7i1aPt8

Source code

github.com/nourinzaman2005-droid/comeback

Demo logins (or tap the demo button)

Player: nourin@comeback.demo, ComeBack2026!

Clinician: maya.rahman@icc-demo.org, CareTeam2026!

The live app runs on a free server. The first sign-in can take up to a minute to wake it.

Appendix B. How does it work?

Private on the phone. Safe in the cloud.

Her phone

- Pose AI (MediaPipe) runs on the device
- Video is never stored or sent
- Rules engine decides what is allowed
- Works offline, syncs later

metrics only, with consent →

Secure API

- Express and PostgreSQL on Render
- Hashed passwords, signed sessions
- Clinicians see only linked players
- No field for video in the database

results and alerts →

Clinician portal

- Check-ins, symptoms, history
- Approve or hold each stage
- Private chat and notifications
- Red-flag alerts

Built with Next.js, TypeScript and Tailwind as an installable web app. Tested with Vitest and Playwright, including automated accessibility checks.

Appendix C. How do we keep her safe?

Four rules. No shortcuts.

1. A stage moves forward only when time, tests, symptoms and a **clinician's approval** all agree.
2. Any warning symptom **stops** progress and tells her to contact her care team.
3. The AI guide only **explains**, with citations. It refuses clearance questions and cannot change a stage.
4. Camera video **stays on the phone**. Only numbers are shared, and only with her consent.

ComeBack supports the medical team. It is not a medical device and never clears a player on its own.

Appendix D. Where does it go next?

From prototype to pilot

Phase 1

Clinical review

Sports physios and doctors review every rule and message.

Phase 2

Pilot with an ICC Member

One board, its players and its medical team. We measure completion, clarity and clinician response time.

Phase 3

Every Member, every sport

More languages. The same six-stage model fits football, netball and other sports.

Free for players. Built to be run by boards and federations as part of player welfare.

Appendix E. Who built it?

Two women. One working product.



Nourin Zaman

Product, player app and camera AI

- Player journey, roadmap and check-ins
- On-device pose tests
- Design, accessibility, four languages
- Offline app, deployment, video and deck



Ashra Rahman

Evidence, safety and backend

- ICC and clinical guideline extraction
- Safety rules engine, fully tested
- Secure API and database
- Clinician portal, chat and alerts

Appendix F. Where do the facts come from?

Sources

1. ICC Return to Play Post-Pregnancy Guidelines and media release, 22 June 2026
2. The Cricket Monthly, "Cricket's mothers have it better now than ever", 8 March 2022
3. MLP Law, Cricket Australia maternity leave, 18 November 2019
4. University of Alberta, FIFA pregnancy and postpartum decision aids, July 2026
5. Goom, Donnelly and Brockwell, Returning to running postnatal, 2019
6. Donnelly et al., the 6 Rs framework, British Journal of Sports Medicine, 2022
7. On-device pose estimation clinical validation, PMC12940220

Photos via Wikimedia Commons: Chamari Athapaththu by Bahnfrend (CC BY-SA 4.0); Nain Abidi and Bismah Maroof by paddynapper (CC BY-SA 2.0); Jay Shah by B4bhavisha (CC BY-SA 4.0). Backgrounds removed. Camera demo input: Pexels stock video.